

# Rightly Guided Caliphs

HIS-300

# Why study the caliphs?

We know from Quran and Hadith, the **first generation is special**. Reading about their lives and personalities is spiritually uplifting.

You come across a wide range of situations for which there was **no direct prophetic precedent**.  
e.g. Compilation and Standardization of Quran, Suspension of Hudūd,

We learn how the best generation lead the ummah in face of a variety of Crises.

Death of the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>, Apostasy and rebellion, Expansion and governance crises, Civil strife

Many modern doubts and sectarian issues are rooted in early history.

We don't want to discuss them but knowing what they are is important

# What aspects will we focus on?

## Personality

- Basic information
- Temperamental traits
- Moral instincts

## Early Life

- Social background
- Pre-Islamic character
- Acceptance of Islam
- Relationship with Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>

## Leadership

- Assumption of leadership
- Leadership philosophy
- Decision-making style
- Handling of disagreement
- Institutional thinking
- Personal ethics in office

## Learnings

- Leadership principles
- Ethical frameworks
- Relevance to modern contexts
- Spiritual takeaways

Hz Abu Bakr Siddique <sup>RA</sup>

# Name

- Abdullah Ibne Uthman
- Abu Bakr (The one who has young camels)
- Al-Ateeq (The Freed one)
- As-Siddiq (one whose entire being is aligned with truth)
  - Opinoin 1: Since before prophethood
  - Opinoin 2: When he became the first one to accept Islam
  - Opinoin 3: At the event of Isra

## Tribe

- From Banu Taym (Quraysh)
- Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> and Hz Abu Bakr <sup>RA</sup> go back 6 generations

# Family

- His father **Uthman (Abu Kuhafa)**

- He accepted Islam at the conquest of Makkah, 90 years of age
- His hair was completely white
- He was brought on a shield, Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> said why didn't you leave him home and we would've come to him. Hz AB <sup>RA</sup> said no he should've come to you
- He wasn't a blatant enemy of Islam but did speak against it from time to time

- His mother **Salma bint Sakhar**

- Accepted Islam very early on in Makkan period

## 4 wives, 6 children in total. 3 sons, 3 daughters.

- From **Kutaila** 1<sup>st</sup> Wife
  - Abdullah bin AB (Who was spying in bazar and reporting in Ghar-e-Saur, 10-12 years)
  - Asma bint Abu Bakr (Had son Abdullah bin Zubayr, when muslims arrived in Medina)
- From **Umme Ruman** 2<sup>nd</sup> wife (passed away 6<sup>th</sup> year of Hijra)
  - Hz Ayesha
  - Abdurrehman
- From **Asma bint Umais** 3<sup>rd</sup> wife (wife of Jafar then AB <sup>RA</sup> then Hz Ali <sup>RA</sup> )
  - Muhammad bin AB (Born in Hajj-tul-wida) (Grows in the household of Hz Ali <sup>RA</sup>, Hz Ali appointed him the governor of Egypt) 1 year old when Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> passed away
- From **Habiba bint Kharija** (Ansari) 4<sup>th</sup> wife. Married in Medina
  - Umme Qulsum (Born after the death of Hz AB <sup>RA</sup>)

The only sahabi to have the entire family to convert to Islam

Abdullah Ibne Zubair -> son of Asma -> daughter of AB <sup>RA</sup> -> son of Abu Kuhafa (4 generations of Sahaba)

**AGE**

Born 2 years after  
the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>

**STATUS**

One of the chiefs of Quraysh

Responsible for the settlement of  
blood-money and debts

**PROFESSION**

Trader

**KNOWLEDGE**

Genealogy  
Interpretation  
of Dreams

**REPUTATION**

Ibn ad-Daghniyyah said  
“You join ties of kinship, you are  
truthful, you attain what others are  
denied, you support those in need,  
you help in difficult times, and you  
are hospitable to the guest”

**CHARACTER**

- Never drank Alcohol
- Never had pre-marital  
relationships
- Never worshiped Idols

**NATURE**

- Very gentle,
- Very soft spoken,
- Beloved by the people

- **PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION**

- Hz Ayesha <sup>RA</sup> said, 'A fair man, of slender build, thin cheeked and with a stoop; he could not keep his lower garment from slipping over his loins; gaunt-faced, eyes deep-set, with a prominent forehead, and the backs of his hands fleshless.
- Used to dye [his hair and beard] with henna

- **ACCEPTANCE OF ISLAM**

- Many narration which claim that he was the first to accept Islam
- But then we also have narrations of Hz Khadija RA to be the first and Hz Ali <sup>RA</sup> being the first
- Imam Abu Hanifa reconciled all these by saying the first man to accept, the first woman to accept and the first from the children to accept.

- **HIS COMPANIONSHIP AND EXPEDITIONS**

- Abu Bakr accompanied the Prophet from the moment he accepted Islam until his death, not leaving him in a journey or in residence,
- He was firm on the Day of Uhud and the Day of Hunayn when all of the people had fled

# A Summary of his Personality

Probably the most important thing to mention about Hz Abu Bakr <sup>RA</sup> is his clarity of thought and decisions when a decision was to be taken. He just knew what the truth was, his instincts were spot on.

## Some Cases in point

- First one to accept Islam
- Hijrat with the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> leaving his family and children behind
- Believing Isra
- His reaction at the Visal of the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>
- Sending of the army of Usama bin Zayd to Syria
- His difference of opinion with the sahaba over important issues and his sticking to his position and giving of Proofs
- Appointment of Hz Umer bin Khattab <sup>RA</sup> as the next caliph

# Assumption of Khilafat

Why did the prophet <sup>SAW</sup> not appoint a caliph?

# Assumption of Khilafat

- **Visaal** of the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>
- Hz Ali <sup>RA</sup>, Hz Abbas <sup>RA</sup> and Ahle-bait busy with Burial
- The Gathering of Ansar at Saqifah Bani Sa'idah -> nominating Sa'd ibn 'Ubadah <sup>RA</sup>
- Muhajireen (including Abu Bakr, Umar, Abu 'Ubaydah) learning about the gathering and going there
- The Deliberations at Saqifah: Arguments and Consensus
  - **Ansar reasoning**
    - We sheltered and defended Islam
    - This is our city; we carried Islam when it was weak
    - We deserve leadership or at least equal share.”
  - **Muhajirun reasoning**
    - Arabia is extremely tribal: wider acceptance may require Quraysh leadership
    - A divided leadership will split the Ummah immediately.
    - The hadith “Imams are from the Quraysh”

# Signs

- **Leading the Prayer:** During his final illness, the Prophet ﷺ consistently instructed, "Tell Abu Bakr to lead the people in prayer."
- **The Hajj Delegation:** In the 9th year of Hijrah, the Prophet ﷺ appointed Abu Bakr to lead the Hajj pilgrimage, a position of great religious and organizational authority.
- **Companionship in the Hijrah:** The singular honor of being the Prophet's sole companion in the Hijrah created an inseparable bond and a testament to his trustworthiness.
- **Hadith:** "I saw myself at a well from which I was drawing water. Then Abu Bakr drew one or two buckets, and there was some weakness in his drawing — and may Allah forgive him. Then ‘Umar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb took the bucket, and it turned into a very large bucket, and I never saw anyone draw water so powerfully." *Sahih Bukhari*
- **Hadith:** A woman came to the Prophet SAW regarding a matter. He instructed her about it. She then said (paraphrased): "What if I come and do not find you?" The Prophet SAW replied: "If you do not find me, then go to Abu Bakr."

- **Verse 100 Surah Tawbah:** “As for the first and foremost of the Emigrants (Muhājirīn) and the Supporters (AnSār) and those who followed them in goodness, Allah is pleased with them and they are pleased with Allah”
- **Verse 40 Surah Tawbah:** “If you do not help him, (it makes no difference to the Prophet, because) Allah has already helped him when the disbelievers expelled him, and he was the second of the two, when they were in the cave, and he was saying to his companion, “Do not grieve. Allah is surely with us.”

# **The matter of delay in pledging allegiance by Hz Ali <sup>RA</sup>**

## **There was a difference of opinion and a rapid political process**

Some, including Ali <sup>RA</sup>, initially felt that the matter should have been deliberated more slowly and inclusively, given their close kinship to the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>. It was a political difference of opinion, not a denial of Abu Bakr's legitimacy or superiority

## **How soon Hz Ali <sup>RA</sup> pledged his allegiance to Hazrat Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup>**

Opinion 1: Days

Opinion 2: 6 months (after the death of Hz Fatima <sup>RA</sup>)

## **Consensus of Ahl al-Sunnah:**

The position of Sunni Islam is that the process, though rushed, resulted in the selection of the most deserving person through the mechanism of Shura among the elite of the Muslims.

# The incident of Qirtas

It was Thursday, a few days before the Prophet SAW passed away. He was severely ill. Several Companions were present in the room. The Prophet's SAW request

“Bring me writing materials so that I may write something for you after which you will never go astray.”

## The disagreement:

Some Companions moved to bring the materials: ‘Umar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb (RA) said (paraphrased):

**“The Prophet SAW is overcome by illness, and the Book of Allah is sufficient for us.”**

A heated disagreement arose in the room.

**“Leave me. It is not appropriate to argue in my presence.”**

He then did not dictate anything in writing.

## **The first Address**

o people! I have been appointed over you though I am not the best of you. If I do good, help me. If I swerve, correct me. Truthfulness is a trust and lying is treachery. The weak of you is strong in my eyes until I secure his right, and the strong of you is weak in my eyes until I take the right from him, if Allah so wills. None among you should give up jihad for as soon as a people give up jihad, Allah afflicts it with humiliation. Obey me as long as I obey Allah and His Messenger and if I disobey Allah, I have no right to obedience from you. Now stand for the prayer, May Allah have mercy on you.

# Army of Usama bin Zayd

- 2 days before the prophet SAW passed away, one of the final commandments he gave was to dispatch an army under Hz Usama bin Zayd RA to Tabuk and beyond (Roman Empire)
- Hz Usama was 18-20 years old, born in the house of Khadija (son of Umme-e-Aiman) Hibbu-Rasoolullah
- Sahaba had concerns over his appointment as some of them even had sons older than him
- Rumors of this reached the prophet <sup>SAW</sup>, on the Saturday before his death, Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> walked into the masjid with support and turban wrapped around the head to soothe the pain. He reassured the sahaba that his decision is correct with regards to his appointment.
- Sunday morning Hz Usama bin Zayd <sup>RA</sup> came to the house of Hz Ayesha <sup>RA</sup> to bid farewell to the prophet <sup>SAW</sup>. The Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> couldn't speak, but pointed upwards and then towards his chest, symbolizing Allah is with you.
- The army of Usama <sup>RA</sup> is stationed outside of Medina and prepping to leave. It takes them a day to fully prep. Just when they're about to leave the news of Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>'s passing away reaches them on Monday morning.
- The entire army comes back on Monday

# Army of Usama bin Zayd

- Later afternoon the Saqifah happens, by evening Hz Abu Bakar RA is the khalifa.
- The first order he gives is that the army cannot stay inside Medina and needs to go back to the camps.
- Next morning Hz Usama sends a message that I'm feeling uneasy leaving you and the city at a time like this. Many other Sahaba felt the same.
- So the next morning a meeting happens lead by Hz Umar RA where he voices the same concern that its not safe to send our best men and resources away at a time like this when there are Munafiqeen and newly converted mushrikeen in the city. An overwhelming majority of the Sahaba were of this opinion.
- Hz Abu Bakar RA asked for time to think. The next day he gave the final decision in a very emotional manner that my conscious cannot go against the decision of the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>. **Went against the counsel of all the Sahaba.**
- The Sahaba requested Hz Umar <sup>RA</sup> to go to his house and at least convince him to change the Ameer. When Hz Umar <sup>RA</sup> made this request, Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> stood up in anger and grabbed Hz Umar <sup>RA</sup>'s beard and said you of all people are saying this?
- We himself came to Jurf (place outside Medina) to wish the army good luck.

# Army of Usama bin Zayd

- The first offensive Jihad after the Prophet SAW
- Hz Abu Bakar's Advice to Usama bin Zayd.
- "Do not act treacherously, do not deceive nor steal from the booty. Do not mutilate, nor kill children or the elderly. Do not dig up date palms nor burn them. Do not chop down fruit-bearing trees. Do not slaughter sheep, cattle and camels unless for purposes of food. If you pass by people who have devoted themselves to monasteries, leave them to their worship. If you come across people who have shaved off the centre of their heads and left the portion surrounding it (resembling a headband/turban), strike their heads off with your sword. When food is offered to you, pronounce the name of Allah over it. O Usamah! Do what the Messenger of Allah ~ ordered you to do with the land of QuQ.a'ah. Then go to Abil and do not fall short in what he ordered." He then bid farewell to him at al-Jurf

# Ridda Wars (Ridda = Turn around -> Murtad)

- 3 types of problematic people
  1. Left Islam (Mostly outside the Hijaz Region)
  2. Accepted False Prophets
  3. Rejected Zakat
    - a) Zakat is not Farz
    - b) Zakat can only be taken by a Prophet

# The Flase Prophets

- **Musaylimah al-Kadhdhāb**

- A Christian who was expecting a prophet before the prophet <sup>SAW</sup> and wanted to be one
- Tribe: Banu Hanifah (Yamamah – Najd region)
- Claimed prophethood during the life of Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>
- Even sent a letter to the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>

- **Sajah bint al-Harith**

- A woman poet from a Christian Arab background
- Tribe: Banu Tamim from Najd (The biggest tribe in Arab)
- Claimed prophethood after the Prophet's <sup>SAW</sup> death
- Famously: Formed an alliance, Married Musaylimah
- After Musaylimah's death: She abandoned her claim
- Accepted Islam genuinely

# The Flase Prophets

- **Sajah** (one of the chieftain of Banu tamim herself) reached out to the other chieftains of her tribe, among them is **Malik Ibne Nawayrah** (Zakat Collector at the time of the prophet SAW)
- Sajah decided to launch a full attack against medina with 40,000 people (these people had gathered around her for political gains, not because they believed)
- On the way to Medina is Yamama, where Musaylima is. So Sajah decides to deal with Masaylima first
- Instead of fighting they end up marrying and joining forces, but delay the war
- Meanwhile Hazrat Abu Bakar sent Hz Khalid bin Walid to annihilate the forces of these two
- Musaylima was killed by Wahshi with the same spear with which he had killed Hz Hamza RA
- Sajah fled to Iraq and later repented sincerely

# The Flase Prophets

- **Tulayhah al-Asadi**

- Tribe: Banu Asad (East of Najd)
- Had fought in the battle of Ahzab / Khandaq on the side of mushriqeen
- Was an astrologer, claimed prophethood during the Prophet's <sup>SAW</sup> lifetime
- Tribes of Ghatafan and Tayy followed him
- Hz Khalid bin Walid sent to kill him, he fled to Syria
- Later: Repented sincerely, Returned to Islam, became a brave Muslim warrior
- He was known for his war tactics. Hz Umer <sup>RA</sup> told Hz Khalid bin Walid <sup>RA</sup> to take advantage of the war expertise of this person in wars against the romans and Persians, but never make him the leader of the army
- Martyred in Jihad against the Persians

# The Zakat Rejectors

- It's easy to call any person Kafir who doesn't believe in one God and Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> as the last messenger
- The problem was with Zakat rejectors
- One category said, we gave the zakat to the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> but we will not give it to you.
- They used the verse Surah Taubah:103 ... (خُذْ مِنْ أَمْوَالِهِمْ صَدَقَةً) “Take Sadaqah (obligatory alms) out of their wealth through which you may cleanse and purify them, and pray for them. Indeed, your prayer is a source of peace for them. And Allah is (All-) Hearing, (All-) Knowing.” saying the pronoun used is singular so its only the Prophet SAW who can take it.
- They were accepting Quran but were interpreting it differently so it's not easy to call them Kafir
- Hz Abu Bakar RA and Hz Umer have an argument over this
- Hz Umer RA conceded and accepted Hz Abu Bakr's Ijtehad on this.

# The Zakat Rejectors

- **Hz Umer's <sup>RA</sup> Argument**

1. "I have been commanded to fight the people until they say: 'La ilaha illallah.' Whoever says it has protected his life and wealth from me..." (Bukhari & Muslim)

- **Hz Abu Bakar's <sup>RA</sup> Argument**

1. Zakat is inseparable from Salah, he famously said:  
"By Allah, I will fight whoever differentiates between Salah and Zakat."
2. Hz Abu Bakr <sup>RA</sup> cited the full version of the hadith 'Umar quoted:  
I have been commanded to fight the people until they testify that there is no god but Allah and that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah, and they establish prayer and give zakat. If they do that, they have protected their blood and their wealth from me, except by the right of Islam, and their reckoning is with Allah

Zakat is a right of Islam, Refusing it removes protection

3. By Allah, if they refuse to give me a kid [young of a goat] which they used to give to the Messenger of Allah, I will fight them

# The Zakat Rejectors

## Discussion point: Were the Zakat Rejectors Muslims or not

- Theological discussion: What is the line between Iman and Kufr
- Historical discussion: Did Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> treat them as Kafirs or not. Incident of Malik bin Nawairah's blood money when Hz Khalid bin Walid <sup>RA</sup> killed him
- One group when brought to Hz Abu Bakr <sup>RA</sup> said we didn't commit Kuft we were just greedy for our money
- Majority opinion suggests that Hz Abu Bakr <sup>RA</sup> fought them as rebels and not Kuffar

# The Zakat Rejectors

## The Battle of Dhul Qissah

- Battle of Dhul Qissah was one of the earliest military encounters during the Ridda Wars
- **Banu Asad and Banu Ghatfan**, under the influence of **Tulayha** sent Representatives to Medina
- The representatives asked to not take Zakat from their tribes
- Upon rejection of the request attacked in the middle of the night, in the absence of the army of Usama
- Hz Abu Bakr <sup>RA</sup> expecting this had positioned some sahaba at key positions on the outskirts of Medina
- And had a group of sahaba ready for battle in the masjid
- Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> himself lead the expedition and was at the forefront to motivate Sahaba.
- The Muslims defeated the two tribes before morning

# Usama's Expedition

- Did not engage in any battle, it became more of a scouting expedition that was beneficial from a strategic lens and a show of power
- Laying Foundation for the eventual conquest of Syria
- Usama's RA army returns
- It is at this point that the Ridda wars officially start, with around 12 armies
- Each army would strike a set of tribes
- +40 skirmishes took place with those 12 armies
- The wars lasted less than or around a year
- Prepared sahaba for the more important and bigger battles that were soon to come
- Prevented Muslims from disintegrating into many many fractions which would have multiplied many-folds in the centuries to come both politically and religiously (multitude of Fiqhs)

# Preservation of Quran

- At the Visal of the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>, Quran had been written down but not gathered
- Why was it not gathered? Because there was no need
  - Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> was alive
  - Quran was growing, ayat being added in different places, verses were being abrogated so it was a work in Progress
  - Numerous companions had memorized it
  - That's how Allah wanted it
- In the battle of Yamama(a huge tribe) (One of the Ridda wars) against Musaylimah Al Kazzab
- Many sahaba were martyred including +70 huffaaz
- Most of these sahaba had memorized a portion of the Quran not the entire Quran. Memorizing the entire Quran was very rare. Estimates are that around 4 sahaba knew the entire Quran by heart during the life of the prophet <sup>SAW</sup>. Because again the Quran was evolving at that time.
- Hz Umar <sup>RA</sup> was concerned about the possibility that if more Huffaaz die then there is a danger of losing Quran or a part of Quran. So he proposes its compilation to Hz Abu Bakar RA.

# Preservation of Quran

- Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> being the strictest follower of Sunnah replied by saying how can I do what the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> did not do.
- Hz Umer <sup>RA</sup> kept on persuading him until he got persuaded
- **Discussion Point:** What is Biddah and What is not.
- The responsibility is given to Hz Zayd bin Thabit <sup>RA</sup>
  - He was the primary scribe of Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> in Medina
  - Closest neighbor of Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> who was a scribe
  - One of the very few who had memorized the entire Quran (Ubai bin Qa'b, Muaz bin Jabal, Ibne Masud)
  - Had the sharpest memory of all the Huffaz, was the youngest
  - He was 11 at the time of Hijrah and had already memorized 17 Surahs
  - Present at the final recitation of Quran in front of Jibrael

# Preservation of Quran

- Hz Zayd bin Thabit <sup>RA</sup> started collecting Quran from people
- Hz Umar bin Khattab <sup>RA</sup> made an announcement from the mimber that who ever has learnt anything from the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> with regards to the Quran should bring it forward. So people started bringing rocks, date bark, camel bones etc on which they had written Quranic verses and they had to give an oath that this is what they heard from the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>
- Hz Abu Bakr <sup>RA</sup> made the criteria that there need to be at least 2 witnesses of every verse. (One from memory and one written)
- The last two verses of Surah Tawbah were with Hz Khuzaima bin Thabit <sup>RA</sup>, those verses were only with him. (In one of the early books on the compilation of Quran it is mentioned that Hz Uthman <sup>RA</sup> verified as the second witness that he had heard those verses from the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>. Secondly a hadith about Hz Khuzaima bin Thabit <sup>RA</sup>, give him the unique privilege of being equal to two witnesses)
- There were no reports of any Sahabi objecting to a verse included that should not have been or a verse that should have been included and was not.
- This compilation takes place within one year of the death of the Prophet <sup>SAW</sup>.
- This Mushaf stayed with Hz Abu Bakar RA till his death and was passed on to Hz Umer bin Khattab RA

# Expansion of Islamic Empire

- More than half the time of Hz Abu Bakar's RA khilafah was spent in the wars of Ridda
- **Discussion points:** Was the expansion justified? Were these battles defensive or Offensive? Does Islam allow offensive Jihad?
- Hz. Abu Bakar RA launched offensive battle against both the Persians and romans at the same time in the 12<sup>th</sup> Hijrah, second year of his caliphate.
- One of the tribal chieftains in the area of Bahrain, who had just converted, **Muthanna Ibn al-Haritha** launched an offensive into towns of Sassanid empire (Now Iraq) and sent the booty to Medina.
- This attack was not ordered by Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> but when Muthanna Ibn al-Haritha reported to Medina with his success and Mal-e-ghanimah, Hz Abu Bakar RA made him in-charge of that region and gave official order to go deeper into the Sassanid empire.
- Hz Khalid bin walid <sup>RA</sup> at the time was just done with the **battle of Aqraba** with Musaylimah and was in Najd area. A messenger was sent to him by Hz Abu Bakr <sup>RA</sup>, ordering him and any soldier who volunteered to go, to join Muthanna in Bahrain and attack the Sassanids. Hz Khalid bin Walid with 10,000 soldiers joined forces with Muthanna who had gathered around 6 - 8,000 soldiers.
- So a total of no more than 18,000 soldiers took on one of the biggest and most ancient civilizations of the world which had 100s of thousands of troops.

# Hz Khalid bin Walid's march to Hira

- Hz Khalid bin Walid is directed to capture the city of Al-Hira
- Around 4-5 battles took place, the most of important of these was the Battle of Chains – Named after a military strategy of the Persians where they used to tied the entire army
- After a clever military strategy the enemy of around 50,000 Persians was defeated
- Terms were offered to the city of Hira
- They opted for paying Jizya since they were already paying a higher tax to the Sassanid rule.
- This lay the foundation of the defeat of Sassanid empire
- During the time of Hz Abu Bakar the entire land of present day Iraq was conquered

# Hz Abu Ubaidah's March to Syria

- Prophet <sup>SAW</sup> had already marched to Tabuk in Syria's direction
- Hz Usama <sup>RA</sup> was also told to go in the same direction and then Hz Abu Bakar had made sure he is sent
- Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> assembled an army in Medina under the leadership of HZ Abu Ubaidah <sup>RA</sup> and marched it to Syria
- This army followed the exact same route to Tabuk
- From Tabuk divided into 4 divisions and followed a different path to Bosra, each concurring lands on the way
- Heraclius is the King of Rome and he appoints his own cousin Theodore to lead against the Muslims
- Hz Abu Ubaidah <sup>RA</sup> fears defeat and sends a message to Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup>
- Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> sends a message to Hz Kahlid bin Walid <sup>RA</sup> to go to Bosra
- Hz Khalid bin Walid takes a route with 10,000 soldiers which had no water and was thus an uncharted territory. This move is so risky that 2 days before they arrive their water runs out and the Muslims barely make it to the destination.
- The attack completely takes the enemy by surprise

# The Battle of Ajnādayn

- 12,000 – 16,000 Muslims against 30,000 – 100,000 romans
- Muslims defeat the Romans and march on to besiege Damascus
- Damascus is one of the main cities of Syria and is arguably one of the oldest cities in the world
- Muslims lay siege to the city and the city falls after a month long siege
- The news of the siege did reach Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> but he died before the victory

# Appointment of Hz Umer RA as the next Caliph

- In Jimad-ul-thani 13 AH Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> got sick and had very high fever
- He felt that his death is near
- Called a group of Sahaba and told them that he will be leaving them soon
- He said it is better that I choose the next Khalifa for you so that you don't fight amongst yourself to which Sahaba said that we respect your judgement
- He already had Hz Umer's name in mind. So he started calling individual sahaba from Muhajiurun and Ansar and asked them about their opinion of Hz Umer <sup>RA</sup>.
- They all unanimously agreed that he's the most fitting for this position amongst them.
- Only Hz Talha bin Ubaid ullah shared a reservation that Hz Umer <sup>RA</sup> is too strict / harsh to which Hz Abu Bakar <sup>RA</sup> responded by saying that Umer compensates for my softness by his harshness
- Once all Sahaba agree Hz Umer <sup>RA</sup> is told about this decision to which he resisted and finally agreed
- Hz Abu Bakar got a document written which was to be read out to everyone.  
"Are you happy with the person whom I chose as caliph over you? I did not appoint a relative, instead I appointed 'Umar. You should therefore listen to him and obey him. By Allah, I spared no effort in coming to a correct decision."  
The Muslims replied: "We hear and we obey."
- Hz Uthman bin Affaan is chosen to oversee the transition and to make sure its smooth
- Everyone gave the oath of allegiance to Umer while Hz Abu Bakar was alive

# Death of Hz Abu Bakar RA

- In the last of those days he could not leave his house
- Hz Umer <sup>RA</sup> took over the leading of the prayer.
- Hz Usman <sup>RA</sup> who was a very good friend of his, used to visit him very often. He asked if he should call a healer and he said, the one who heals has already seen my situation and has already given me a verdict.
- During the last days he said to Hz Ayesha <sup>RA</sup>, you are the most beloved to me in my family. He told her to calculate his wealth and see what he possessed that he did not have when he became the khalifa and give it to Hz Umer <sup>RA</sup>. When Hz Ayesha <sup>RA</sup> calculated he had one more servant and one more camel than when he assumed the office. They were sent to Hz Umer.
- When Hz Umer <sup>RA</sup> received the things, he started crying and said, O Abu Bakar you have made it very difficult for anyone after you.
- Afternoon of Monday 22<sup>nd</sup> of Jimad-ul-thani he asked Hz Ayesha <sup>RA</sup>, which day did the Prophet SAW die, and she said it was Monday, he said inshAllah between now and tonight. He wanted to follow the sunnah to that level.

# Death of Hz Abu Bakar RA

- He told Hz Ayesha to use the old cloth that they had and use that as his Kafan after washing as the living are in more need of new cloth.
- He ordered that Hz Asma bin Umais wash his body and that he be buried in the house of Hz Ayesha RA.
- He died shortly after giving all these waseyats while reciting the ayat

تَوَفَّنِي مُسْلِمًا وَأَلْحِقْنِي بِالصَّالِحِينَ

*“Cause me to die as a Muslim and join me with the righteous.”*  
(Qur’an 12:101)

- Hz Umer RA lead the janaza prayer
- He passed away in the exact age as that of the Prphet SAW i.e. 63 years

# Advice to Hz Umer RA

Oh Umer! Always fear Allah SWT. And realize the Allah is owed worship at night that cannot be done during the day and Allah is owed worship during the day that cannot be done during the night. And know that Allah will not accept a Nafal until the Farz has been done and remember what Allah has mentioned the people of Jannah he mentions their good deeds and overlooks their bad deeds so when you read about them have hope that you will be among them and when he mentions the people of jahanam Allah mentions their bad deeds and he rejected their good deeds so when you read about them be scared that you might be amongst them and always be between fear and hope.